

Espresso Dial-In Tracker

The ratio reference, then a log. Change one variable at a time and write down what it did. That is the whole method.

BREW RATIO REFERENCE

Ratio is dose in against liquid out, measured by weight. An 18 g dose pulling 36 g into the cup is 1:2. These are common landing zones, not rules.

Ratio	Typical time	What it tends to taste like
Ristretto 1:1 to 1:1.5	20-30 s	Thick and syrupy. Sweetness concentrated, acidity muted. Turns hollow and bitter quickly if the grind is too fine.
Normale 1:2	25-32 s	The default starting point for most modern espresso. Body balanced against clarity.
Long 1:2.5 to 1:3	28-35 s	Lighter body, more clarity and aromatics. Suits light roasts. Tips thin and sour past the window.
Lungo 1:4 and beyond	35 s +	Tea-like. Easy to push into dry, papery bitterness.

READING THE SHOT

What you taste	Usual cause	First thing to try
Sour, thin, watery	Under-extracted	Grind finer, or raise dose, or extend time. Change ONE.
Bitter, drying, harsh finish	Over-extracted	Grind coarser, or shorten time, or drop temperature.
Fast gusher, pale crema	Channelling, or too coarse	Redistribute and level before tamping, then grind finer.
Drips and never opens up	Too fine, or dose too high	Grind coarser, or drop the dose by 0.5 g.

Change one variable per shot. If you move grind and dose together you learn nothing from the result, and you will be standing here again tomorrow.

SHOT LOG

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DATE	BEAN / ROASTER	ROAST DATE	DOSE G	YIELD G	TIME S	GRIND	TEMP	TASTE	NEXT CHANGE